

SAM PRATT

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EDUCATION

- 2025 – **University of California, Los Angeles**
PhD in Psychology
PI: Dr. Matthew Lieberman
- 2019 – 2023 **Harvard University**
B.A. in Psychology
GPA: 3.97
Magna Cum Laude with Highest Honors

FORMAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2023 – 2025 *Lab Manager, Deepest Beliefs Lab*
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
PI: Kurt Gray, PhD
- 2021 – 2023 *Research Assistant, Laboratory for Anxiety & Related Disorders*
Harvard University
PI: Richard J. McNally, PhD (Conducted senior honors thesis)
- 2021 Winter;
2023 Spring *Research Assistant, Laboratory on Complex Thought and Cooperation*
Harvard University
PI: Joshua Greene, PhD
- 2020 Summer *Research Assistant, Laboratory for Youth Mental Health*
Harvard University
PI: John Weisz, PhD

HONORS AND AWARDS

- 2026 **NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program (GRFP)** awardee
- 2026 **UCLA Graduate Research Mentorship Award** (\$30,000)
- 2026 **UCLA Graduate Summer Research Mentorship Award**, (\$6,000)
- 2025 **Editor's Choice Award** for Sending Signals publication in *JEP:A*
- 2025 **NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program**, Honorable Mention
- 2025 **Edwin W. Pauley Award** (\$30,000), awarded to two incoming Psychology PhD students at UCLA
- 2024 **Harvard Institute for Quantitative Social Science Grant** (\$16,000)
- 2023 **Phi Beta Kappa**, awarded to top 10% of graduating class, Harvard University
- 2023 **Summa Cum Laude**, Senior Honors Thesis in Psychology, Harvard University
- 2023 **Psychology Faculty Prize** for outstanding senior honors thesis, Harvard University
- 2023 **Highest Honors** in the field of Psychology, Harvard University
- 2023 **Seamus P. Malin Award**, for outstanding teamwork and dedication to Harvard Men's Soccer
- 2022 **Harvard College Research Program Grant** (\$5,000) for senior honors thesis
- 2022 **Harvard College Research Program Grant** (\$1,000) for senior honors thesis
- 2022 **John Harvard Scholar**, awarded to the top 5% of junior class, Harvard University
- 2021 **John Harvard Scholar**, awarded to the top 5% of sophomore class, Harvard University
- 2021 **Harvard College Research Program Grant** (\$1,000) for independent research
- 2020 **Academic All-Ivy League**, awarded to one member of each varsity sports team, Harvard University

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Pratt, S.**, Jones, P. J., Bellet, B. W., McNally, R. & Gray, K. (2026). The words can harm scale: Measuring beliefs about harmful speech. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 257. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2026.113785>
- Womick, J., Kubin, E., Goya-Tocchetto, D., Ochoa, N. R., Rebollar, C., Kapsaskis, K., **Pratt, S.**, Devine, H., Payne, B. K., Vaisey, S. & Gray, K. (2026). Liberals and Conservatives See Different Victims: Moral Disagreement Is Explained by Different Assumptions of Vulnerability. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/01461672261422957>
- Pratt, S.**, Rosenfeld, D. L., Goranson, A., Tomiyama, A. J., Sheeran, P. & Gray, K. (2025). Health behaviors are moralized when perceived to cause harm. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/01461672251372823>
- Pratt, S.**^{*}, Jones, P. J.^{*}, Bridgland, V. M. E., Bellet, B. W., & McNally, R. J. (2025). Sending signals: trigger warnings and safe space notifications. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Applied*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1037/xap0000541> †
- Gray, K. & **Pratt, S.** (2025). Morality in our mind and across cultures and politics. *Annual Review of Psychology*, 76: 663-691. <https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev-psych-020924-124236>
- Worsnip, A., Lane, D., **Pratt, S.**, Napolitano, G. M., Gray, K., & Greene, J. A. (2025). Authority or autonomy? Philosophical and psychological perspectives on deference to experts. *Philosophical Psychology*, 1-36. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09515089.2025.2475138>
- Rodriguez, M., **Pratt, S.**, Bellet, B. W., & McNally, R. J. (2023). Solitude can be good—If you see it as such: Reappraisal helps lonely people experience solitude more positively. *Journal of Personality*, 93 (1): 118-135. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jopy.12887> ‡

* These authors contributed equally to this work.

† Selected as an Editor's Choice paper in *JEP:A*

‡ Recognized as a top 10 Most Cited and top 10% Most Viewed article of 2023 by the *Journal of Personality*

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

- Pratt, S.**, Bellet, B. W., Jones, P. J., & McNally, R. J. (2024). *Testing the coddling hypothesis: Campus safetyism and student resilience*. *PsyArXiv*. <https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/zav5g>
- Sarkar, A., Sella, F., Rebollar, C., Ibata, N. G. O., **Pratt, S.**, Kahane, G., Gray, K., Savulesco, J., Elliot, A. J., & Thompson, J. M. (2025). *Social impressions shape moral decisions*. Manuscript in preparation.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

- Bai, F., Chan, S., Dong, Y., Tierney, W., Celniker, J., **Pratt, S.**, Gray, K., Clark, C. J., ... & Uhlmann, E. L. (2024). *Person-centered moral judgments: Replicability, cross-cultural generalizability, and theoretical integration*. Ongoing large-scale project.

INVITED TALKS

- Pratt, S.** (June, 2025). *How Camp Shapes Us: The Psychology of Belonging*. Invited talk presented in person at YMCA Camp Belknap, Wolfeboro, New Hampshire.
- Pratt, S.** & Kubin, E. (April, 2025). *Testing True Victimhood Beliefs Across Cultures and Contexts*. Invited talk presented in person at the Templeton World Charity Foundation grant cohort meeting, Listening and Learning in a Polarized World, Marrakesh, Morocco.

Pratt, S. & Gray, K. (October, 2024). *The Roots of Moral Disagreement and How to Find Common Ground*. Invited talk presented virtually at St. Paul's High School.

PODCASTS

Guest, *Outrage Overload Podcast*. Episode 63: Moral Psychology and the Harm-Based Roots of Political Polarization. Interviewed by David Beckemeyer. April 30, 2025. <https://outrageoverload.net/outrage-63-how-perceptions-of-harm-drive-moral-outrage-and-political-conflict-samuel-pratt/>

EDITED BOOKS

Assisted with research, writing, and editing for....Gray, K. (January 14, 2025). *Outraged: Why We Fight About Morality and Politics and How to Find Common Ground*. Pantheon. <https://www.amazon.com/Outraged-Morality-Politics-Common-Ground/dp/0593317432>

CONFERENCE POSTERS

Pratt, S. & Gray, K. "Harm denial: A source of political animosity and a potential solution." Poster presented by S. Pratt at the annual convention for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology (February, 2024, San Diego, CA).

Pratt, S., Rodriguez, M., Bellet, B. W., & McNally, R. J. "Alone but not lonely: Brief cognitive interventions for lonely individuals." Poster presented by S. Pratt at the annual convention for the American Psychological Association (August 2023, Washington, D.C.).

Pratt, S., Rodriguez, M., Bellet, B. W., & McNally, R. J. "Alone but not lonely: Cognitive reappraisal helps lonely individuals experience time alone more positively." Poster presented by S. Pratt at the annual convention for the Society of Personality and Social Psychology (February 2023, Atlanta, GA).

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT & SCIENCE WRITING

Pratt, S. (2026, April). Can words harm? My new measure that sparked Twitter outrage. *Train of Thought*. <https://sampratt.substack.com/p/can-words-harm>

Pratt, S. (2026, April). Most students want trigger warnings: They don't actually help. *The Science Matters*. <https://thesciencematters.org/most-students-want-trigger-warnings-they-dont-actually-help/>

Pratt, S., Jones, P., & Bridgland, V. (2025, September). Want a more supportive classroom? Skip the trigger warning. *SPSP Character and Context Blog*. <https://spsp.org/news/character-and-context-blog/pratt-jones-bridgland-supportive-classroom-safe-space-messages-trigger-warnings>

Gray, K., Devine, H., & **Pratt, S.** (2025, April). Strip club physics: Serious decisions need serious settings. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/strip-club-physics>

Gray, K., **Pratt, S.**, & Devine, H. (2025, February). AI is more moral than you (And the NYTimes' best ethicist). *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/ai-is-more-moral-than-you>

Gray, K., & **Pratt, S.** (2025, January). Why grandma's cookies taste so good (Or: When I gave electric shocks to Harvard undergraduates). *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/why-grandmas-cookies-taste-so-good>

Gray, K., **Pratt, S.**, & Devine, H. (2024, December). How the DMV saved Christmas: Shared irritation brings us together. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/how-the-dmv-saved-christmas>

Gray, K., Devine, H., & **Pratt, S.** (2024, December). The assassination of a CEO: Why some celebrate the pain of the

powerful. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/the-assassination-of-a-ceo>

Gray, K., **Pratt, S.**, & Devine, H. (2024, November). In defense of flat earthers: Conspiracy theorists are more logical than you think. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/in-defense-of-flat-earthers>

Gray, K., Devine, H., & **Pratt, S.** (2024, November). Moving forward: The 2024 election and the curse of knowledge. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/moving-forward>

Gray, K., Devine, H., & **Pratt, S.** (2024, October). The psychology of pettiness: Why (some) people get so angry at line-cutting and grape-stealing. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/the-psychology-of-petty>

Gray, K. & **Pratt, S.** (2024, September). The problem with moral psychology: What science says about moral truths and romancing your sibling. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/the-problem-with-moral-psychology>

Gray, K., **Pratt, S.**, & Puryear, C. (2024, April). DANGER! Why MORAL PANICS(!) are irresistible to your brain. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/danger-why-moral-panics-are-irresistible>

Pratt, S. & Gray, K. (2024, February). Being alone doesn't make you a killer (OR: would Henry David Thoreau be a mass shooter in 2024?). *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/being-alone-doesnt-make-you-a-killer>

Gray, K., & **Pratt, S.** (2024, January). Hidden brain and evil explain: Lessons from death threats. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/hidden-brain-and-evil-explain>

Rodriguez, M., **Pratt, S.**, & Bellet, B. (2023, November). Improving our relationship to being alone. *SPSP Character & Context Blog*. <https://spsp.org/news/character-and-context-blog/rodriguez-pratt-bellet-benefits-perceptions-solitude-loneliness>

Gray, K., **Pratt, S.**, & Blakey, W. (2023, October). The Myopia of Heroism: Hamas, Israel, and the quest to save victims. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/the-myopia-of-heroism>

Gray, K., Blakey W., & **Pratt, S.** (2023, August). Charitable condescension: You're not a saint for thinking "they" are stupid. *The Moral Understanding Substack*. <https://www.moralunderstandingnewsletter.com/p/charitable-condescension>

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2026 Spring	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> , PSYCH-10 Introductory Psychology, UCLA
2023 Fall	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> , "The Science of Moral Understanding," UNC Chapel Hill
2023 Summer	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> , "Becoming a Brain Scientist: Neuroscience and Psychology Research," Harvard Summer School

AFFILIATIONS AND SERVICE

2025 –	Psychology in Action, University of California, Los Angeles
2024 –	Advisory committee member, Institute for Multipartisan Education
2023 –	Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP)
2022 – 2023	Psychology Undergraduate Planning Committee, Harvard University

TECHNICAL SKILLS

RStudio, Qualtrics, Microsoft Office, Amazon Mechanical Turk, CloudResearch, Prolific